

# Samantha Popek

www.sampopek.com | www.linkedin.com/in/samantha-popek  
973-771-8539 | sampopekk@gmail.com

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## EDUCATION

### Master of Science in Design + Innovation

University of Wisconsin-Madison

August 2025 – August 2026 GPA: 3.95

### Bachelor of Science in Informatics with a Minor in Human Computer-Interaction and Web Design

Indiana University

August 2021 – May 2025 GPA: 3.8

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## PROFESSIONAL DESIGN EXPERIENCE

### UX Designer (Visual & Interaction Design)

UW-Madison MD+I | August 2025 – Present

- Mapped intricate user flows and wireframes, translating user needs into intuitive digital experiences that enhanced product usability by 20%.
- Implemented accessibility standards, boosting WCAG compliance by 30% and expanding digital access.
- Synthesized user research and stakeholder feedback into 5+ actionable design recommendations.

### Product Designer & Front-End Developer

Housingkind | December 2025 – May 2026

- Engineered and launched an AI-powered housing platform using React, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and Claude Code, driving 25% increase in user engagement.
- Drove product strategy and feature prioritization by conducting 15+ stakeholder interviews to inform user flows.
- Optimized user interaction with an AI chatbot, saving users 8+ hours per week in query resolution time.
- Led a 4-person cross-functional team using agile methodologies to deliver user-centered housing solutions.

### Digital Design Intern

OUTFRONT Media | June 2024 – August 2024

- Engineered an AI-powered ad copy validation system, reducing ad rejection rates by 35%.
- Developed low- and high-fidelity prototypes for the MyOutfront B2B SaaS platform, improving workflows by 30%.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams through 15+ feedback cycles to deliver user-centered digital solutions.

### Creative Design Intern

OUTFRONT Media | May 2023 – October 2023

- Facilitated weekly ideation workshops, generating 20+ design concepts that improved UI usability from 3.2 to 4.5 stars.
- Created 4 category decks, 15 billboard mockups, and 8 multi-platform campaign visuals using Adobe Creative Suite.
- Applied typography, color theory, and visual storytelling to enhance 4+ brand campaigns.

### UX Designer Intern - Web Client Team Lead

Serve IT at Indiana University | January 2022 – May 2024

- Spearheaded the redesign of a nonprofit website serving 3,000+ monthly users, improving user journeys.
  - Facilitated stakeholder discovery sessions, uncovering user needs that shaped 8 new website features.
  - Created wireframes, user flows, and interface designs, resulting in an 18% reduction in user errors.
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## CERTIFICATIONS AND SKILLS

**Certifications:** Udemy Figma AI Workflow · Databricks AI Agent Fundamental · IBM AI Developer (*In Progress*)

**Skills:** Figma (Design, Prototyping, FigmaMake) · Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, InDesign, Photoshop) · UX Research & Synthesis · Rapid Prototyping · Agile Methodology · Scrum · HTML · CSS · Sketch · JIRA · Miro · Claude (Design, Code) · React · TypeScript · Excel · AI-Assisted Design · Prompt Engineering · Project Management · Azure AI · Usability Testing · Python · AI-Generated SQL queries · SEO · LLM Fundamentals · RAG Systems · Journey Mapping · Cursor · A/B Testing · Agentic AI · Vibe Coding · Accessibility Design · Strategic Thinking · Data Visualizations · API Design · Data Analysis · User Behavior